

Deployment Guide

The app is hosted on **Vercel** (client + API) with the database on **Render**.

A. Run locally

1. Install Node.js and PostgreSQL.
2. Create the database: `createdb sports_hub`.
3. Backend:

```
cd server
cp .env.example .env      # fill in DB details, PORT, JWT_SECRET
npm install
npm run migrate
npm run seed
npm run dev
```

4. Frontend:

```
cd client
cp .env.example .env      # set VITE_API_URL
npm install
npm run dev
```

5. Open <http://localhost:5173>. Admin: `admin@sportshub.local` / `admin123`.

B. Deploy online

1. Database (Render)

- Create a PostgreSQL instance on Render and copy its connection string.

2. Create the tables

- Put the connection string as `DATABASE_URL` in `server/.env`, then run `npm run migrate` and `npm run seed` once (this fills the cloud database).

3. Vercel

- Import the GitHub repo into Vercel (keep Root Directory as the repo root — the `vercel.json` file handles the build).
- Add these environment variables in Vercel:
 - `DATABASE_URL` — the Render connection string
 - `JWT_SECRET` — a long random string
 - `CLIENT_URL` — your Vercel site URL
- Deploy. The client is served at the site root and the API at `/api`.

Notes

- Keep `PORT` (server) and `VITE_API_URL` (client) matching when running locally.
- Never commit the `.env` file (it holds secrets).